Communication Flow

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Business communication involves the exchange of information within members of an organization and from the organization to outside parties. These patterns of communication are called **flows**, these flows can occur in multiple directions of interaction.

1 Upward Communication:

Like the name suggests, upward communication deals with any interaction that travels up the hierarchy of your business. The most common example is when a direct report communicates to a supervisor or manager. Another instance is when a managerreaches out to directors or high-level executives.

2 Downward Communication:

Downward communication refers to the exchange of information from the top of an organization to lower levels of the organizational hierarchy. Although the direction is the opposite of upward communication, these two types often work hand in hand.

1. **Lateral or Horizontal Communication**

- When employees communicate across departments or with peers of equal rank in the organization, this is considered lateral or horizontal communication. Lateralcommunication examples include a coworker calling another coworker or a team of managers deliberating a potential new hire

- **Diagonal Communication:**

- Diagonal communication is when a manager works with employees from another department or work group. This is utilized in instances like when a manager is creating a training module and works with employees from various departments to ensure that th
training is accurate, or when a project spans across multiple departments. Effective

- diagonal communication leads to uniformity across an organization, and helps prevent any misunderstanding that may occur through the communication chain.

1. **External communication**

- External communication deals with the exchange of information from within the organization to parties outside of the organization. For example, a team within your company may send over a proposal for an outreach campaign to a client or your organization may issue a press release to promote a new product or service.

- Recipients of external communication include customers, lawmakers, suppliers, and other community stakeholders. Annual reports, press releases, product promotions, financial reports are examples of external communication.

- This is the way how communication flows in every direction in an organization.